Agnostic Inc.
33 Bloor Street East, Suite 801
Toronto, ON M4W 3H1

VANGUARD

Vanguard x UofT AI Partnership

Vanguard® x agnostic

The Ask

Vanguard is entering into a new collaborative research partnership with the University of Toronto to jointly advance AI research. As part of this initiative, Vanguard is planning to hire 90 people to fill out its AI team.

Agnostic was tasked with generating awareness around the announcement, with the goal of advancing Vanguard's technology leadership story in Canada.

Plan Recap

To strategically secure earned media coverage for the partnership announcement, Agnostic provided support in developing media assets, executing media outreach, and coordinating interviews.

Media Assets

Drafted relevant media assets, including media pitch and media list, and provided guidance on assets developed by Vanguard.

PR Strategy

Developed a media strategy for outreach. Offered tier-1 media the opportunity to review the materials under embargo.

Media Training

Led media training for Vanguard spokespeople ahead of the announcement, talking through key messaging and interview scenarios.

Outreach

Facilitated exclusive pitch under embargo. Conducted day-of media outreach to tech, investing, financial, and business outlets across Canada.

Media Approach

We used the intense media focus on AI as an opportunity to engage technology reporters for this story, and highlight Vanguard's leadership within this space. Our PR work typically centres on investing and finance media, so this was a unique opportunity to engage new reporters and media outlets.

We pitched the announcement **as an exclusive** to The Canadian Press to increase the likelihood of coverage. We anchored our story on the broader community impact and how over 90 AI jobs were being created in Toronto. We then conducted broader media outreach to a wider set of media, including **technology**, **general business, investing, and local Toronto** reporters.

As a result of our outreach the announcement was **covered by news media across the country,** including national and local media. We also secured coverage in several top-tier tech trades, a first for Vanguard in Canada.

UofT AI Partnership

Coverage Results

5 Unique Coverage Pieces

64 Total Media Hits

+40.9M

Total Impressions

Coverage Highlights

THE CANADIAN PRESS

Vanguard, UofT launch AI partnership that will create several research labs

CTV NEWS

Vanguard, UofT launch AI partnership that will create several research labs

TORONTO STAR

Vanguard, UofT launch AI partnership that will create several research labs

betakit

University of Toronto and Vanguard team up to expand AI research in finance

fintech.ca

Seeking to Advance Fintech Innovation, Vanguard Taps Canadian AI Expertise

TORONTO TODAY.ca

UofT partners with Vanguard to apply AI to financial sector

Top Quotes

THE CANADIAN PRESS

"The pair say their partnership is aimed at advancing AI research and innovation for investors and the financial services industry."

betakit

"The partnership will see the university's CS department establish several labs of professors, post-doctoral fellows, and students that will collaborate with Vanguard's Toronto-based AI research team."

TORONTO TODAY.ca

"The program will expand the investment company's AI team in Toronto to 90 positions, while giving internship opportunities to UofT students, according to Vanguard. Students will contribute to research papers on financial services AI and work on real-world projects."

fintech.ca

"The initiative, in collaboration with the Department of Computer Science at the University of Toronto, will leverage the school's artificial intelligence and machine learning program, which has been ranked among the top worldwide."

Thank You